CAPSTONE 01 · PERSONAL AI OPERATING SYSTEM · SOLUTION BRIEF

How to build your workspace, step by step.

Ten steps across one week. Each gives you the click path, a worked example and a check to run before you move on.

TOTAL TIME	STEPS	WORKED EXAMPLE	PLAN
About six hours	Ten, in order	Meera, marketing manager	Pro or above, for Skills

THE SYSTEM YOU ARE BUILDING

Project
Instructions of 150+ words and one file. The context every chat starts with.

Skill
Your most frequent output, as a written procedure Claude follows.

Connector
Live access to one tool you use, such as Google Drive.

↓ used in ↓

Task 1 · writing
Leans on the Skill.

Task 2 · analysis
Leans on the Connector.

Task 3 · question
Leans on the Project context.

↓ minutes logged ↓

One-page write-up and a 6–8 slide deck
The setup, what it saves you each week, and what you changed after the first run.

THE WEEK

DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5
Set up	**Task 1**	**Task 2**	**Task 3 + fix**	**Submit**
Choose tasks, build the Project, Skill and Connector.	Run the writing task end to end.	Run the analysis task end to end.	Run the last task, then refine.	Write it up and build the deck.
`Steps 01-06 · 2 h`	`Step 07 · 30 min`	`Step 07 · 30 min`	`Steps 07-08 · 1 h`	`Steps 09-10 · 2.5 h`

BEFORE YOU START

- [ ] Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise. Custom Skills are not on Free.
- [ ] **Code execution and file creation** on, in Settings → Capabilities.
- [ ] One finished example of your most frequent output.
- [ ] Sign-in access to the tool you will connect.
- [ ] A note or sheet to log minutes per task.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA

Meera is a marketing manager at Lumen, a direct-to-consumer skincare brand. She reports to the founder every Monday and preps a weekly agency call. Her setup appears at every step: copy the shape, then use your own details.

Menus move between releases. If a label differs, look under Customize or Settings.

01

15 MINUTES · DAY 1

Choose your three tasks.

01 List everything you produce or decide in a normal week. Circle the things that happen every week, not once a quarter.

02 Pick three of different shapes: one **writing** task, one **analysis** task, and one **question or planning** task.

03 For each, note the input, the output, who reads it, and the minutes it takes today. These are your "before" figures; time them this week if unsure.

04 Mark your most frequent output: it becomes the Skill in step 05. Mark the task that needs another tool's data: it uses the Connector.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S THREE TASKS

TASK	SHAPE	INPUT	OUTPUT AND READER	MIN NOW
Monday founder update	Writing	Sales export and her notes	A 150-word update for the founder	45
Weekly campaign review	Analysis	Campaign tracker sheet in Google Drive	The three changes that matter, for her team	30
Agency call prep	Question	Last update and the tracker	Questions, objections and one goal, for herself	25

The founder update is her most frequent output, so it becomes her Skill. The campaign review needs Drive, so it uses her Connector.

× AVOID Choosing tasks you do rarely. You must run all three this week, on real inputs.

✓ CHECK Three tasks, each with an input, an output, a reader and a minutes figure.

02

5 MINUTES · DAY 1 · MODULE 2.4

Create the Project.

`Projects` → `+ New project` → `Name and description` → `Create project`

01 Open **Projects** in the left sidebar and click **+ New project**.

02 Name it after the **area of work**, not a single task. All three of your tasks should belong in it.

03 Add a one-line description. It is for people; Claude works from the instructions you write next.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA

Name: Lumen · weekly marketing · **Description:** Founder updates, campaign reviews and agency prep for Lumen.

× AVOID One Project per task. Three Projects means writing your context three times.

✓ CHECK The Project is in your sidebar, with no instructions or files yet.

03

20 MINUTES · DAY 1 · MODULE 2.4

Write the custom instructions, 150 words or more.

Instructions are Claude's standing brief for every chat in the Project. Write them in the order below: who you are, who reads your work, how it should sound and look, the hard rules, and what good looks like. The last part matters most and is what most people skip.

TEMPLATE · REPLACE EVERY BRACKET

I am [role] at [company]. This Project covers [the area of work].
My readers are [who]. They need [what they need from my work].
Tone: [three words]. Default format: [prose, bullets or table, and length].
Always: [two or three rules]. Never: [two or three things to avoid].
If a request is unclear, ask me one short question before writing.
Good work here looks like: [a concrete description, or a line from a past output you liked].

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S INSTRUCTIONS · 182 WORDS

I'm Meera, marketing manager at Lumen, a direct-to-consumer skincare brand that sells online in India. This Project covers my weekly reporting, campaign reviews and preparation for agency calls.

My main reader is our founder, who wants numbers and decisions, and reads on her phone between meetings. My second reader is my team of three, who need clear next actions.

Tone: plain, direct and specific. Default format: short paragraphs and at most one bullet list. Lead with the number or the decision, then the reason.

Always use figures exactly as they appear in my files, and say when you have rounded or assumed something. Always end with what you need from me. Never invent numbers, use marketing jargon or pad with general advice. If a request is unclear, ask me one short question first.

Good work here is an update the founder can act on in two minutes: three numbers, what moved them, one risk and one ask. The best one I wrote opened with "Revenue up 8% week on week, driven by the serum restock" and kept every point to one line.

`Your Project` → `Instructions` → `Edit` → `Paste` → `Save`

01 Paste your finished text into the Project's instructions and save.

02 Count the words. If you are under 150, add detail to "Good work here looks like". Do not pad the other lines.

03 Open a new chat inside the Project and ask: *"In three lines, what do you know about my work and how I want outputs written?"*

× AVOID Adjectives with no test behind them, such as "high quality" or "professional". Name the reader, the length and the rule instead.

✓ CHECK The instructions run to 150+ words, and the test chat plays back your role, your reader and your format correctly.

04

5 MINUTES · DAY 1 · MODULE 2.4

Upload at least one file to the Project.

`Your Project` → `Files` → `+` → `Upload from device`

01 Choose the file Claude would otherwise ask you for: best is a past output you were happy with, then a style guide, a template or a standing reference.

02 Upload it to the **Project**, not into a single chat, so every chat in the Project can read it.

03 In a new Project chat, ask: *"Which parts of the uploaded file would you use when writing my [output]?"*

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA

She uploads **Founder update, week 44.pdf**, the update she named in her instructions as the best she has written.

✓ CHECK Claude names specific content from your file, such as a heading, a figure or a phrase, rather than giving general advice.

05

60 MINUTES · DAY 1 · MODULE 2.6

Build the Skill.

A Skill is a folder with one required file, `SKILL.md`: a name, a description of when to use it, and the steps Claude follows. Claude loads the steps only when your request matches the description, so a clear description is what makes it fire.

● ROUTE A · RECOMMENDED

Build it with Claude

01 Turn on the built-in **skill-creator** Skill:
`Customize` → `Skills` → `skill-creator` → `On`

02 In a chat, send the prompt below with your real example pasted in.

03 Answer Claude's questions. It writes the Skill and packages it as a ZIP file.

04 Download the ZIP, then upload it:
`Customize` → `Skills` → `+` → `Upload a skill`

ROUTE B

Write it yourself

01 Create a folder named in lowercase with hyphens, such as `weekly-founder-update`.

02 Inside it, create `SKILL.md`, following the example on the next page.

03 Zip the **folder**, so the folder sits at the top of the ZIP, not loose files.

04 Upload the ZIP by the same path as Route A.

PROMPT FOR ROUTE A

Help me create a skill for [the output]. I write it [how often] for [reader], from [inputs]. Here is a finished one I'm happy with: [paste it]. Ask me questions until you can write the steps, then package it as a skill I can upload.

05

CONTINUED

What a good Skill file looks like, and how to test it.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S SKILL.MD

```
---
name: weekly-founder-update
description: Writes Meera's Monday update for Lumen's founder from the week's sales
  export and her notes. Use when asked for the weekly update, Monday update or
  founder update.
---

# Weekly founder update

## Steps
1. Read the sales export and the notes. If either is missing, ask for it.
2. Pick the three figures that moved most week on week, choosing only from
   revenue, orders and cost per acquisition. Quote them exactly.
3. For each figure, write one line on what moved it. Mark anything inferred
   as "likely".
4. Add one risk and one ask.

## Format
- Subject line: "Week [n]: [headline figure]"
- Under 150 words. Sections: Numbers · What moved them · Risk · Ask
- Show each figure in rupees and as % change.

## Voice
Plain and direct. No jargon, no exclamation marks.

## Example of a good update
[paste the week 44 update]
```

Test it in four passes. Change the steps, not only the output, so the fix holds next week. Older menus show Skills under Settings → Capabilities.

01 **Turn it on** in Customize → Skills, then open a new chat inside your Project.

02 **Run it on a real input** from this week: *"Write this week's founder update. Export attached, notes below."* Claude's reply shows when it reads a Skill.

03 **Write down exactly what is wrong.** Then edit the step that caused it, re-zip and re-upload, or ask Claude to revise the Skill for you.

04 **Run it again on a second real input.** Stop when the output needs only light edits.

× AVOID A vague description such as "Helps with updates". Say what it makes, from what, and the words you will use to ask for it.

✓ CHECK The second real input produces an output you would send after light edits, and you have a note of what you changed between runs.

06

10 MINUTES · DAY 1 · MODULE 4.1

Connect one tool you genuinely use.

`Customize` → `Connectors` → `+ Browse connectors` → `Your tool` → `Connect` → `Sign in`

01 Open Customize → Connectors. Older menus show it as Settings → Connectors.

02 Choose the tool your analysis task needs, such as Google Drive, Gmail or Calendar, and click **Connect**.

03 **Before you approve, read what it can access.** Connectors get read access to your data, and some can also write. Connect only what the task needs.

04 Sign in with your own account and approve.

05 In a Project chat, open the **+** menu beside the message box and confirm the connector is switched on for that chat.

06 Ask a question only the connector can answer, then open the source yourself and compare.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA CONNECTS GOOGLE DRIVE

Test prompt: *"Find the sheet called 'Campaign tracker – Nov' in my Drive. List its column headers and give me the total spend in the last row."* She opens the sheet and confirms the total matches to the rupee.

On Team and Enterprise plans, an owner must first enable the connector under Organization settings → Connectors. Then you connect your own account as above.

✓ CHECK The connector's answer matches the source you opened yourself. If it does not, you have found the limit of the connector before it mattered.

07

DAYS 2 TO 4 · ABOUT 30 MINUTES EACH

Run the three tasks end to end.

One task a day, always inside the Project. Each run follows the same five moves.

01 **Write the prompt with the formula:** your role or context, plus what you want, plus format and constraints, plus the reader or purpose. The Project already holds your role, so focus on the task.

02 **Name the piece the task leans on:** "Use the weekly founder update skill", or "Open the tracker in my Drive".

03 **Read the whole response before reacting.** Find the one thing that is wrong.

04 **Push back at least once,** specifically: "Cut it to half", "Rank by effect on revenue", "Question 2 is too polite."

05 **Save the finished output** where it will be used, or as an Artifact, and log the minutes. Count your review and edits, not only Claude's reply time.

07

CONTINUED · WORKED EXAMPLE

Meera's three runs, prompt by prompt.

Task 1 · Monday founder update

SKILL + PROJECT FILE · 45 → 15 MIN

> Use the weekly founder update skill. This is week 46. The sales export is attached and my notes are below. [notes pasted]

PUSH BACK The founder will ask for rupee figures, not only percentages. Show both for every number.

Task 2 · Weekly campaign review

CONNECTOR · 30 → 12 MIN

> Open 'Campaign tracker – Nov' in my Drive. Compare this week with last week for each campaign. Which three changes matter most, and what is the likely cause of each? Quote the figures from the sheet, and flag any cell that looks wrong.

PUSH BACK Drop the commentary on impressions. Rank the three by effect on revenue.

Task 3 · Agency call prep

PROJECT CONTEXT · 25 → 10 MIN

> I have a 30-minute call with our performance agency on Thursday. Using last week's founder update and the campaign tracker, give me the three hardest questions to ask, the two objections they are likely to raise with my answer to each, and the one outcome I need from the call.

PUSH BACK Question 2 is too polite. Make it specific to the retargeting spend.

THE LOG · KEEP ONE ROW PER TASK

TASK	LEANS ON	BEFORE	WITH SETUP	SAVED	OUTPUT SAVED TO
Founder update	Skill + file	45	15	30	Email to founder
Campaign review	Connector	30	12	18	Team notes doc
Agency call prep	Project	25	10	15	Call agenda
Per week		**100**	**37**	**63**	**minutes**

✓ CHECK Three finished outputs, saved where they are used, and three complete rows in your log.

08

30 MINUTES · DAY 4

Refine after the first run.

01 Go back through your three runs and answer three questions. Which instruction did Claude ignore? Which step of the Skill produced the wrong thing? Did the Connector return the right source?

02 Fix each problem where it started: the Project instructions, the Skill's steps, or your prompt. A fix there holds next week; a fix in one chat does not.

03 Check what Claude remembers about you, and correct anything wrong:

`Settings` → `Capabilities` → `Memory`

04 Edit the existing Project and Skill. Do not start again; a targeted edit keeps what already works.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S THREE FIXES

WHAT WENT WRONG	FIXED IN	THE CHANGE
Founder wanted rupees, got percentages	Project instructions	Added "show rupee value and % change"
Skill led with impressions	Skill, step 2	"Choose only from revenue, orders and cost per acquisition"
Drive opened October's tracker	Prompt habit	Always name the file and the tab

✓ CHECK A written list of at least three changes, each made in the place the problem started.

09

60 MINUTES · DAY 5

Write the one-page write-up.

Five sections, in order, inside the word budgets. Every number comes from your log.

SECTION	WHAT GOES IN IT	WORDS
1 · The setup	What the Project, the Skill and the Connector each do, in two sentences each	90
2 · Three tasks	Your log table: task, what it leans on, minutes before and with the setup	table
3 · What it saves	The weekly saving with the sum shown, and what you will do with the time	60
4 · What changed	Your fixes from step 08, and what each one taught you	80
5 · What I keep	What you will keep using, what you will drop, and what you will build next	60

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S SECTION 3, OPENING LINE

"The setup saves me (45 − 15) + (30 − 12) + (25 − 10) = 63 minutes a week, about 50 hours over a 48-week year. The minutes include my own review and edits."

✓ CHECK It fits on one page, every figure appears in your log, and anything estimated says so.

10

90 MINUTES · DAY 5

Build the deck, then submit.

Seven slides. Each headline is a full sentence that states the point. Someone who has never seen your work should be able to rebuild the setup from the deck alone.

#	HEADLINE, AS MEERA WROTE IT	WHAT TO SHOW
1	**I re-explained the same context every week.**	The three tasks and the minutes before
2	**One Project holds my standing context.**	Screenshot of the instructions and the uploaded file
3	**One Skill writes my Monday update.**	The Skill's steps and one finished output
4	**Google Drive feeds the campaign review.**	The connector screen and the check you ran
5	**Three tasks, 63 minutes back a week.**	The log table
6	**Three fixes after the first run.**	The fixes table from step 08
7	**What I keep, and what I build next.**	The next Skill or Connector you would add

PROMPT · IN A PROJECT CHAT, WITH YOUR WRITE-UP PASTED IN

Turn this write-up into a 7-slide deck. One idea per slide, each headline a full sentence that states the point, and a clear placeholder where each screenshot goes. Plain layout, no stock images, no words on a slide that are not in my write-up.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- [ ] Project: 150+ word instructions and one file
- [ ] Skill: tested on two real inputs, used in a task
- [ ] Connector: used in a task, checked at source
- [ ] Three finished outputs and a complete log
- [ ] Write-up on one page; deck of 6–8 slides
- [ ] Client names and confidential figures removed

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Skills missing or greyed out	Turn on code execution in Settings → Capabilities, or ask your org owner.
Skill upload fails	Zip the folder, not its contents. SKILL.md needs a name and description.
Skill never fires	Make the description say when to use it, or name the Skill in your prompt.
Connector finds the wrong file	Name the exact file and tab. Reconnect it in Customize → Connectors.
Output feels generic	Your instructions lack a reader, a length or a "good looks like".